



MINUTES OF THE REGULAR BOARD MEETING

Wednesday, 12 March 2025, 6:00 p.m. · Board Room, 100 Reservoir Road

Present: Miguel Ferreira (Chair), Hana Sato, Ruth Abernathy, Karol Ostrowski, Benedict Mensah, Ayesha Qureshi

Absent: Leon Varga (excused)

Staff: Dana Okafor (General Manager), Lena Kowalczyk (Finance Officer), Tomás Ibarra (Operations Superintendent), Priya Raman (Board Secretary)

1. Call to order

The Chair called the meeting to order at 6:02 p.m. A quorum was present.

2. Minutes of the previous meeting

The minutes of the regular meeting of 12 February 2025 were approved as presented (moved by Director Mensah, seconded by Director Qureshi; approved 6-0).

3. Travel and Per Diem Policy

The Finance Officer presented the revised Travel and Per Diem Policy (Policy No. 2025-03), which raises the in-state per diem from \$55 to \$65 and sets new lodging limits. The Board adopted **Resolution No. 2025-09** approving the policy, effective 1 April 2025 (moved by Director Sato, seconded by Director Abernathy; approved 6-0).

4. Alder Street main break

The Operations Superintendent reported on the main break of 3 February 2025 (Incident Report IR-2025-004): 214 customers lost water for up to eleven hours and a boil-water advisory was in force until 6 February. Repairs cost \$38,760. Directors asked how many cast-iron mains of the same age remain; staff estimated 6.8 miles. The Board directed staff to propose an accelerated cast-iron main replacement program in the FY2026 budget.

5. Water rate study

The Board authorized the General Manager to engage Clearwater Rate Advisors for a cost-of-service rate study, at a cost not to exceed \$28,000 (approved 5-1, Director Ostrowski opposed). A public hearing on any rate change will be held in May.

6. Pump Station 4 bids

Four bids were opened on 7 March 2025. Staff will evaluate them and recommend an award at the April meeting.

7. Adjournment

There being no further business, the meeting was adjourned at 7:42 p.m. The next regular meeting is on 9 April 2025.

Priya Raman

Priya Raman, Board Secretary

Miguel Ferreira

Approved: Miguel Ferreira, Board Chair